Oxford, Connecticut in the Naugatuck Valley has a long history as a rural farming community that evolved into a growing residential suburb (2020 census pop. 12,706). Originally home to the Pootatuck and Paugussett peoples, it was later shaped by English settlers and 18th-century industry

Key Historical Milestones

- **Settlement and Incorporation**: The area was first settled by colonists from Derby, Stratford, and New Haven around the 1680s. It was established as a separate parish in 1741 and officially incorporated as a town in **October 1798**, carved from parts of Derby and Southbury.
- **The Oxford Turnpike**: In 1795, the Oxford Turnpike Company was formed, creating a privately funded road (now roughly Route 67) to move goods from Litchfield County to New Haven ports.
- **Industrial Shift**: Early manufacturing utilized local waterpower for sawmills, gristmills, and wool processing. By the mid-19th century, tanneries in the area were known for producing harnesses and leather goods, including specialized cases for early photography (daguerreotypes).
- **First Nylon Parachute Test**: On June 6, 1942, Oxford resident, Adeline Gray, made history as the first person to jump with a nylon parachute during World War II, a critical advancement for the military.
- **2001 Anthrax Attacks**: Oxford gained international attention in November 2001 when 94-year-old resident Ottilie Lundgren became the fifth and final victim of the U.S. anthrax mail attacks.
- **Historical Weather Events**: In August 2024, Oxford recorded 16.31 inches of rain in a single day—the **greatest rainfall in Connecticut's history**—shattering the previous state record set in 1955.

Notable Historic Sites

Twitchell-Rowland Homestead - A colonia-era farmhouse (c. 1755) that now serves as a museum for the **Oxford Historical Society.** 60 Tower Lane, Open the 1st and 3rd Sunday every month, 2-4pm, Free. Drop in and experience Oxford's living history. The 1755 Twitchell-Rowland Homestead was saved from destruction and relocated to its current site at 60 Towner Lane thanks to community support of a

historic level. Pictures of the historic house move and regular monthly displays of Oxford life and living are featured. Books on Oxford are on sale, photo notecards and T-shirts sup- port the ongoing maintenance of the Homestead and Society activities.

The Oxford House Tavern - Built in 1795 as the Oxford Hotel, this former inn served travelers on the Turnpike and remains a landmark in the center of town.

Since 2018, the Oxford House Tavern in Oxford, CT, also known as the Oxford House restaurant, is a popular local establishment celebrated for its welcoming atmosphere and diverse menu. This Oxford tavern CT typically offers a range of classic American dishes, including burgers, main entrees, and appetizers, alongside a selection of beers and cocktails. The Oxford Tavern house often serves as a social hub for the community, hosting events and providing a relaxed setting for dining and gathering. 441 Oxford Road, Oxford, Connecticut 06478, United States, 203-463-8904, 7 days a week, 11:30am-10pm, 2023-463-8904

Quaker Farms Historic District - Listed on the National Register of Historic Places, this area features architecture dating back to the 1720s, reflecting the town's early colonial growth. The Quaker Farms Historic District is a historic district in the town of Oxford, Connecticut, United States. It encompasses a small rural village on Quaker Farms Road anchored by the Christ Church

Episcopal, an 1812 wood-frame church with Federal and Gothic styling, located at 470 Quaker Farms Road.

Washband Tavern - Dating to 1714, it is one of the oldest buildings in town and served as a major stop for stagecoaches

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In 1714, John Twitchell (c. 1699-1739) built a small one-story with attic dwelling at what is now 90 Oxford Road in Oxford. Around 1741 the Washband (or Washburn) family purchased the property and enlarged the house to serve as a tavern. In 1784, coinciding with the opening of the Oxford Turnpike, the family enlarged the building again, adding what amounted to a new house attached to the old one. The Washband family operated the tavern for several generations. Before the Civil War, the tavern was a stop on the Underground Railroad. Hiding places are said to exist in the cellar. The former tavern is now home to Daoud & Associate

Southford Falls State Park, 175 Quaker Farms Road, Southbury, Ct. Located on the Oxford-Southbury line, this 169-acre park is the site

of the old Diamond Match Company. It offers fishing, picnicking, field sports, hiking, ice-skating, cross-country skiing and sledding. Southford Falls State Park is a designated Trout Park and is open year-round at no charge. 8am to sunset, pets leashed. (10-minute drive from MHR)

Southford Falls State Park

Oxford & Southbury, Connecticut

0.1 0.05 0 0.1 0.2 Miles

Southbury

Oxford

188

67

Hulls Hill Rd

Park Entrance

Papermill Pond

Covered Bridge

Eightmile Brook

Plaster House Rd

Oakcrest Drive

Boardwalk

(0.13)R
(0.10)R
(0.22)R
(0.20)R
(0.06)R
(0.09)R
(0.04)BW
(0.06)
(0.46)R
(0.35)R
(0.10)R
(0.05)
(0.10)
(0.11)

The boundaries of State-owned properties as shown on this map are approximate.

The trails at Southford Falls State Park are non motorized multi-use only.

Trail distances between marks (★) are in miles.

Southford Falls Picnic Shelter Location
N41° 27' 27.9"
W73° 09' 50.8"

Explanation

- Handicapped Fishing Area
- Parking Area
- Picnic Area
- Picnic Shelter
- Composting Toilet
- Fire Tower
- Falls
- Water Spigot

Trails

- Red - R
- No Blaze
- Boardwalk - BW
- Bridge
- Southford Falls State Park

N W E S

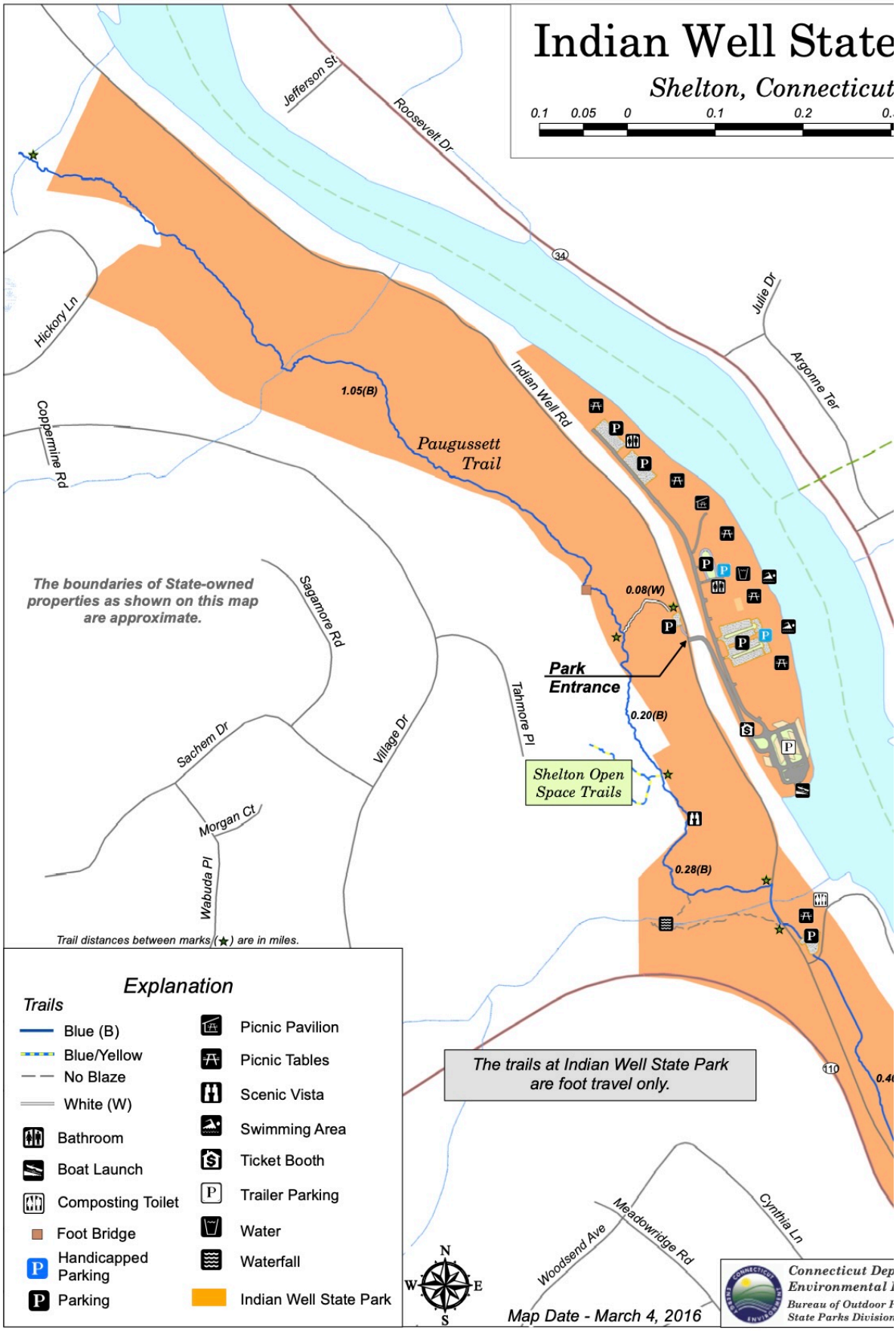
Connecticut Department of Environmental Protection
Bureau of Outdoor Recreation
State Parks Division

Map Date - April 25, 2011

Funding provided by the Federal Highways Adminsitration Recreational Trails Grants Program administered by the Connecticut Department of Environmental Protection (DEP)

Indian Well State Park is a public recreation area occupying 153 acres on the west bank of Lake Housatonic, an impoundment of the Housatonic River, within the city limits of Shelton, Connecticut. The state park's scenic features include 15-foot horsetail waterfalls with splash pool at bottom, located at 1 Indian Well Rd, Shelton, CT 06484 (15-minute drive from MHR)

ctparks.com


Indian Well State
Shelton, Connecticut
0.1 0.05 0 0.1 0.2
Jefferson St
Roosevelt Dr
34
Hickory Ln
Coppermine Rd
Julie Dr
Argonne Ter
Indian Well Rd
1.05(B)
Paugussett Trail
The boundaries of State-owned properties as shown on this map are approximate.
Segamore Rd
0.08(W)
Park Entrance
Tahmore Pl
0.20(B)
Sachem Dr
Village Dr
Shelton Open Space Trails
Morgan Ct
Wabuda Pl
0.28(B)
Trail distances between marks (★) are in miles.
Explanation
Trails
Blue (B)
Blue/Yellow
No Blaze
White (W)
Bathroom
Boat Launch
Composting Toilet
Foot Bridge
Handicapped Parking
Parking
Picnic Pavilion
Picnic Tables
Scenic Vista
Swimming Area
Ticket Booth
Trailer Parking
Water
Waterfall
Indian Well State Park
The trails at Indian Well State Park are foot travel only.
110
Meadowridge Rd
Woodsend Ave
Cynthia Ln
N
W
E
S
Map Date - March 4, 2016
Connecticut Dep
Environmental
Bureau of Outdoor
State Parks Division

Oxford School Houses – Oxford was served by 15 distinct schools in 1837 reflecting its history as a rural, agricultural community. These one-room schoolhouses, designed for local convenience, were later consolidated, leaving the town with its modern, centralized school system. The town's early education focused on reading, writing, and arithmetic for all ages. One example remaining is **Mr. Munn's Schoolhouse** (c. 1850). Originally a private academy for boys located at 561 Oxford Road, it later served as a public high school for the First School District. Students reportedly carved their names and initials into the cellar beams, which remain visible today. In 2016, the building was moved to 60 Tower Lane to be part of the town's historical museum site. Another is **Rimmon Schoolhouse,** (c. 1779) when the area was still part of Derby, it became **Oxford District #6** upon the town's incorporation in 1798. It remained part of Oxford until the town of Beacon Falls was formed in 1871. It is located near the intersection of Rimmon Hill Road and 10 Pines Bridge Road in Beacon Falls,